

POWER BI DEVELOPER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

1 Data Refresh Failure Scenario

Your scheduled refresh fails with the error: *"Data source credential missing or invalid"* for a dataset connected to an on-prem SQL Server via Gateway.

What steps will you take to identify and resolve the issue?

2 Slow Report Performance

A dashboard takes **20+ seconds** to load. The fact table has 50M rows.

How will you diagnose performance issues and what optimizations will you apply?

(Example: modeling changes, disabling "Auto Date/Time", DAX optimizations, summarization, aggregation tables, etc.)

3 Dynamic Month-to-Date (MTD) & Prior MTD

You have a slicer for **Month** and you need:

- Current MTD
- Previous MTD
- MTD Growth %

Explain how you will write the DAX and ensure it works even if the user selects multiple months.

4 Row-Level Security (RLS) with Multiple Roles

Your sales dataset contains Dealer > Region > Country hierarchy.

Users should see data only for their assigned **Dealer** or **Region**.

Some managers want access to **multiple regions**.

How will you design and implement RLS dynamically?

5 Multiple Fact Tables With Shared Dimensions

You have 3 fact tables (Sales, Inventory, Returns) coming from different systems. The date column names and grain differ across sources.

How do you build a star schema in Power BI and handle mismatched granularity?

6 Need to Show Last Non-Blank Value

In a monitoring dashboard, some metrics update only once a week. You need to show the **most recent non-blank value** for each metric. Write a DAX measure to achieve this.

7 Incremental Refresh Scenario

Your table has 30M+ rows and you want to enable incremental refresh. However, the source database does not store rows with modified timestamps. **How will you design the incremental refresh logic?** (Example: using RangeStart/RangeEnd, surrogate “LastUpdatedAt”, or detecting changes.)

8 Handling Multiple Date Columns

A fact table contains **Order Date, Ship Date, Delivery Date**. Your report needs time intelligence on all three. **How will you model date tables and relationships?** (Example: role-playing dimensions, inactive relationships, USERRELATIONSHIP.)

9 Create a Dynamic Top N Based on User Input

A stakeholder wants a chart to dynamically show **Top N products**, where *N* is selected by the user (5, 10, 20). **Explain how you will implement this in Power BI using parameters and DAX.**

10 DirectQuery Performance Issue

Your report uses DirectQuery on Azure SQL DB. Stakeholders complain about slow visuals. **How will you improve performance without switching to Import Mode?**

(Examples: aggregations, composite models, query folding, DAX optimizations, reducing cardinality.)

Power BI Service Scenarios

Dataset Refresh Takes Too Long / Timeout

Your dataset refresh on Power BI Service takes **2+ hours** and eventually times out.

What steps will you take to analyze & fix the issue in Power BI Service?

(Consider: query folding, gateway load, partitioning, incremental refresh, long-running SQL queries.)

Gateway Connection Issue

Your dataset refresh fails saying:

"On-premises Gateway is not reachable"

But the gateway is installed and running.

What would you troubleshoot and what could be the reasons?

Workspace Access Issue

A user cannot view a report even after you added them as a **Viewer** to the workspace.

What might be the possible reasons and how will you resolve the access issue?

Reports Consume Too Much Capacity in Premium

Your Premium capacity admin complains that a dataset is consuming heavy memory and causing throttling.

How will you identify the dataset causing it and optimize it?

App Deployment Issue

You made updates to multiple dashboards & reports inside a workspace, but the business users do not see the changes in the **published app**.
Why does this happen and what steps will you take?

● DAX & Calculations Scenarios

6 Incorrect Totals in a Matrix

A measure shows correct values at the row level but the **total is showing incorrect numbers** in the matrix.

How will you debug and fix the issue?

(Example: using SUMX, HASONEVALUE, removing filters.)

7 Dynamic Target Calculation

You have a table where yearly targets are stored by **Year + Category**, but the report needs to break targets into **monthly values dynamically**, based only on available dates.

How will you write such DAX?

8 Calculate Active Customers for Any Selected Date

You must calculate:

“Number of active customers on any selected date.”

Customers become active when they place their **first order** and remain active until churn (90 days of inactivity).

How will you write DAX to determine active customers?

● Power BI Visuals & UX Scenarios

9 Visual Interaction Conflicts

Users complain that clicking slicers or charts is filtering visuals unexpectedly or not filtering at all.

How will you identify and fix the visual interaction issues in the report?

10 Conditional Formatting Based on Dynamic Threshold

A KPI card must turn **red, yellow, or green** based on dynamic thresholds entered by the user (through parameters or What-If slicers).

How will you implement this with DAX + conditional formatting?

pratik jugant mohapatra